

Clause Segmentation Guidelines

Clause Segmentation Task Description

As a preprocessing step for narrative analysis based on the Labov model, the text is divided into segments at the level of **clauses**. A clause is a structural unit of a sentence that consists of one predicate and several elements that depend on it (see the glossary for definitions of a clause). When a complex sentence contains more than one clause, please extract the **main clause** and the **subordinate clause(s)** separately, following the rules below.

Rules

1. Clauses that function as subjects or predicates, or that modify nouns or verbs, are not treated as independent clauses (except as noted in Rule 5)

- **Do not split** sentences within the underlined portions in the examples below. In other words, none of the following example sentences should be divided mid-way.
 - “Kuchibashi ga akai no ga bun-chō desu.” – The clause functions as the **subject**.
 - “Fujisan wa katachi ga ii.” – The clause functions as the **predicate**.
 - “Chichi ga kika-sete kureta hanashi o omoidashita” – The clause modifies a **noun** (relative clause).
 - “Otōto wa kimochi ga yo-sō ni nemutte iru” – The clause modifies a **verb** (adverbial clause).

Example

- **Before segmentation:** “Because the cat that the child loved became ill, we went to the animal hospital.”
- **After segmentation (correct):** “Because the cat that the child loved became ill, we went to the animal hospital.”
- **Incorrect segmentation:** “The child loved [it]”; “The cat became ill, so we went to the animal hospital.”

2. Quoted sentences are generally not recognized as individual clauses. Only when there is no quoting clause (e.g., “He said, ‘That’s right,’” the “said” part) should the quotation be treated as a single clause.

- In interview transcripts, quotation marks are not always present. Assume that places where quotation marks should be added for semantic clarity do indeed contain quotes and determine clause structure accordingly.

Example 1

- **Before:** “The child came into the room and said, ‘I’m hungry.’”
- **After (correct):** “The child came into the room and said, ‘I’m hungry.’” (kept as one clause)
- **Incorrect:** “The child came into the room”; “I’m hungry”; “said.”

Example 2

- **Before:** “The child came into the room and said like this, ‘I’m hungry.’”
- **After (correct):** “The child came into the room and said like this, ‘I’m hungry.’” (kept as one clause)
- **Incorrect:** “The child came into the room and said like this,” “I’m hungry.”

3. Even an independent clause is not treated as separate if it functions to modify the main clause.

- In sentences such as “Tarō said as if he were surprised,” a subordinate clause that describes the manner or state of the main action (a **manner clause**) modifies the main clause and is not regarded as an independent clause. Phrases like “~ to iu kanji de/yō de/katachi de ○○ shita” (“did ○○ in a way that ...”) are also treated as manner clauses.

Example

- **Before:** “Today, like saying ‘Let’s wrap things up,’ the conversation naturally came together.”
- **After (correct):** “Today, like saying ‘Let’s wrap things up,’ the conversation naturally came together.” (kept as one clause)

- **Incorrect:** “Today, like saying ‘Let’s wrap things up,’” “the conversation naturally came together.”

4. When a clause modifies formal nouns such as “toki” (time), “koro” (around), “baai” (case), or “tokoro” (place/moment), follow the rules below:

4.1 If a phrase like “~ toki/koro/baai/tokoro...” specifies time, place, or conditions and modifies the state expressed by the main clause, segment it as one clause.

Example

- **Before:** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.”
- **After (correct):** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.” (split after “when I came to Tokyo,”)
- **Incorrect:** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.” (no split)

4.2 Even if particles like “ni,” “kara,” or “made” are attached to “~ toki/koro/baai/tokoro...,” if the conjunctive particle specifies the temporal or locational circumstances and modifies the state expressed by the main clause, segment it as one clause

Example

- **Before:** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.” (the Japanese uses “toki ni,” with the particle “ni”)
- **After (correct):** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.” (split at the comma)
- **Incorrect:** “When I came to Tokyo, I bought this bag.” (no split)

4.3 When “~ toki/koro/baai/tokoro...” serves as the topic of the sentence, split it.

Example

- **Before:** “When I first came to Tokyo, everything looked fresh to me.”
- **After (correct):** “When I first came to Tokyo, everything looked fresh to me.” (split after the topic)
- **Incorrect:** “When I first came to Tokyo, everything looked fresh to me.” (no split)

4.4 When “~ toki/koro/baai/tokoro...” functions as the subject or complement, or acts as a relative clause, do not split.

Example 1

- **Before:** “The time when I first came to Tokyo was the most enjoyable.”
- **After (correct):** “The time when I first came to Tokyo was the most enjoyable.” (no split)
- **Incorrect:** “The time when I first came to Tokyo was,” “the most enjoyable.”

Example 2

- **Before:** “The happiest time was when I first came to Tokyo.”
- **After (correct):** “The happiest time was when I first came to Tokyo.” (no split)
- **Incorrect:** “The happiest time was,” “when I first came to Tokyo.”

Example 3

- **Before:** “I still vividly remember my memories from when I entered university.”
- **After (correct):** “I still vividly remember my memories from when I entered university.” (no split)
- **Incorrect:** “I still vividly remember my memories from when I entered university.” (split mid-sentence)

4.5 Compound connective expressions like “kekka” (“as a result”) or “eikyō de” (“due to”) are also treated as formal nouns.

Example

- **Before:** “As a result of studying hard for the entrance exam, I was able to enter university safely.”
- **After (correct):** “As a result of studying hard for the entrance exam, I was able to enter university safely.” (split after the conjunctive phrase)
- **Incorrect:** “As a result of studying hard for the entrance exam, I was able to enter university safely.” (no split)

5. Recognize clause boundaries not only at sentence-final particles or the plain verb form, but also after the te-form or continuative form of verbs, conjunctive particles, or nominal endings, and split there.

1. **Sentence-final particles:** e.g., the “ka” in “O-genki desu ka?” (“Are you well?”) or the “ne” in “Tanaka-san desu ne.” (“So you are Mr. Tanaka”).
2. **Te-form of verbs:** e.g., “tabete” (“having eaten”), “itte” (“having gone”).
3. **Continuative (ren’yō) form:** e.g., “tabemasu,” “tabe-nagara” (“while eating”).
4. **Conjunctive particles:** e.g., “~ kara,” “~ node.” (see the list of conjunctive particles in the glossary).
5. **Nominal endings:** e.g., “Ashita yasumi.” (“Off tomorrow.”), “Kore kansei.” (“This is complete.”), “to iu kanji.” (“It feels like that.”)

Example

- **Before:** “I would call my friends, and gradually I felt like I was in Hawaii.”
- **After (correct):** “I would call my friends, and gradually I felt like I was in Hawaii.” (split after the comma)
- **Incorrect:** “I would call my friends, and gradually I felt like I was in Hawaii.” (no split)

6. When items connected by “toka,” “ka,” “ya,” or “yara” are nouns listed in parallel, do not split them. If multiple clauses are paralleled, then split them.

Example 1

- **Before:** “I tidied up the laundry and the scattered clothes.”
- **After (correct):** “I tidied up the laundry and the scattered clothes.” (no split)
- **Incorrect:** “Laundry,” “I tidied up the scattered clothes.”

Example 2

- **Before:** “I did things like doing the laundry and tidying up clothes.”
- **After (correct):** “I did things like doing the laundry and tidying up clothes.” (split after the comma)

- **Incorrect:** “I did things like doing the laundry and tidying up clothes.” (no split)

7. If the speaker inserts supplementary information in the middle of their utterance, include the insertion as part of the same clause.

- The insertion is a place where, if enclosed by dashes (—) it reads naturally, even if dashes are not present in the transcript. For example, “Watashi ga mainichi, sentaku shi ni—ano, jibun no ie kara aruite—itte imashita.” (“Every day I would go to do laundry, um, walking from my own house.”)

Example

- **Before:** “Every day I would go to do laundry, um, walking from my own house.”
- **After (correct):** “Every day I would go to do laundry, um, walking from my own house.” (kept as one clause)
- **Incorrect:** “Every day I would go to do laundry,” “um, walking from my own house,” “I went.”

8. When the speaker clarifies the referent of a demonstrative pronoun like “sore,” “kore,” or “are” by using a noun, group the clause containing the pronoun together with the supplementary information into a single clause.

- Clarification of the referent may precede the clause containing the pronoun or follow it. See the examples below.

Example 1

- **Before:** “The washing machine. I really wanted this.”
- **After (correct):** “The washing machine. I really wanted this.” (treated as one clause)
- **Incorrect:** “The washing machine.” “I really wanted this.”

Example 2

- **Before:** “That was really hard. The daily laundry...”
- **After (correct):** “That was really hard. The daily laundry...” (kept as one clause)

- **Incorrect:** “That was really hard.” “The daily laundry...”

9. In places where a speaker appears to be correcting themselves, do not separate the corrected phrase; attach it to the clause after the correction.

- Distinguish between **insertion** and **self-correction** as follows:
 - In an insertion, removing the inserted portion yields a natural sentence.
 - In self-correction, removing the corrected expression yields a natural sentence.

Example of self-correction

- **Before:** “My friend said, ‘How about starting tennis,’ and invited me.”
- **After (correct):** “My friend said, ‘How about starting tennis,’ and invited me.” (kept as one clause)
- **Incorrect:** “My friend said, ‘How about starting tennis,’” “and invited me.”

Example easily mistaken for self-correction

- **Before:** “We take our time watching TV after dinner; we like music programs, so we record them and watch them together.”
- **After (correct):** “We take our time watching TV after dinner; we like music programs, so we record them; and we watch them together.” The inserted portion is “we like music programs, so we record them.”
- **Incorrect:** “We take our time watching TV after dinner; we like music programs, so we record them.” “We watch them together.”

Other Rules

- **Keep punctuation** in the transcription. If you split at a punctuation mark, the mark should remain at the end of the clause.
- In oral storytelling, modifiers and the words they modify do not always appear in the usual order. Even if the order is reversed or there is some distance, try to identify clause boundaries by grouping meaningful units. For example, the utterance “Tanoshikatta n desu, hanashitari suru no ga, sugoku” (“It was fun, talking and all,

very much so”) can be rephrased as “Hanashitari suru no ga sugoku tanoshikatta n desu.” If the meaning does not change, count it as one clause.

- Consider the possibility of omitted predicates (for example, “O-sentaku toka gohan wa watashi” might omit “I did them”).
- Include back-channel responses even if they are followed by a period.
- There is no need to segment the interviewer’s utterances (those enclosed in parentheses).

Kodama (2000) Segmentation Example

Original text

それで、洗濯がガーッと回ってる間に、友達なんかに電話して、ハワイだなーってだんだんこう馴染んでくるわけ。そいで、洗濯んところまで、洗濯機まで行ったら、洗濯機がこわれてたの。お水がボアーっと出て、ウワーっと思って、友達に電話しようと思ったら電話も切れてたの。

Segmented text

それで、洗濯がガーッと回ってる間に、

友達なんかに電話して、

ハワイだなーってだんだんこう馴染んでくるわけ。

そいで、洗濯んところまで、洗濯機まで行ったら、

洗濯機がこわれてたの。

お水がボアーっと出て、

ウワーっと思って、

友達に電話しようと思ったら

電話も切れてたの。

Glossary

1. Clause

“A clause is a structural element of a sentence consisting of a single predicate and several elements that depend on it. Semantically, a clause expresses roughly one event or matter.” (*Contemporary Japanese Grammar I*, p. 12)

Example: “Kuki wa, mada seimei ga minagiri, shikkari to tatte iru no ni, akai hana wa kanzen ni kusari, shiroi hana mo hanabira ga chijimi, kare-kakete ita.” (The stems are still full of life and standing firm, but the red flowers have completely rotted, and the white flowers’ petals have shriveled and are withering.)

This sentence contains five clauses:

1. “Kuki wa, mada seimei ga minagiri” (The stems are still full of life)
2. “(Kuki wa) shikkari to tatte iru no ni” (Even though [the stems] are standing firm)
3. “Akai hana wa kanzen ni kusari” and “Shiroi hana mo hanabira ga chijimi” (The red flowers have completely rotted; the white flowers’ petals have shrunk)
4. “(Shiroi hana mo) kare-kakete ita” ([The white flowers] were withering)

2. Subordinate Clause

In sentences like those below, the clause containing the final predicate is the **main clause** and the other clause is the **subordinate clause**.

- “If you take this medicine, your fever will go down.” – “If you take this medicine” is the subordinate clause; “your fever will go down” is the main clause.
- “I watched a movie and shopped.” – “I watched a movie” is the subordinate clause; “shopped” is the main clause.

Complex sentences may have more than one subordinate clause:

- “If you ask Mr. Suzuki, you will probably find out the address of Mr. Satō, who moved last week.” – “If you ask Mr. Suzuki” and “who moved last week” are subordinate clauses; “you will probably find out Mr. Satō’s address” is the main clause.

3. Predicate

Various parts of speech can serve as predicates. Typical forms (from *Nihongo Bunpō ga Waku Jiten*) include:

- **Noun only** – Example: “Konkai ga shōnenba.” (“This is the decisive moment.”)

- **Noun + auxiliary verb or particle** – Example: “Untenshu wa kimi da.” (“You are the driver.”)
- **Verb predicate** – Example: “Neko ga neko-jarashi de asobu.” (“A cat plays with a cat toy.”)
- **Adjective (i-adjective) predicate** – Example: “Sora ga aoi.” (“The sky is blue.”)
- **Adjectival noun (na-adjective) predicate** – Example: “Kaigo wa taihen da.” (“Caregiving is hard.”)
- **Stem of a predicative word only** – Example: “Watashi no kazoku wa minna kenkō.” (“My family is all healthy.”); “Hizashi ga tsuyokute, kao wa makkuro.” (“The sunlight is strong, and my face is completely tanned.”)
- **Adverb only** – Example: “Kyō mo nama gomi ga dossari.” (“There’s a pile of organic waste again today.”); “Isoide iru no wa naze?” (“Why are you in such a hurry?”)
- **Adverb + auxiliary verb or particle** – Example: “Anata no misu wa hon no chotto desu.” (“Your mistake is just a little.”)

4. Manner Clause

- “A manner clause is a subordinate clause that describes the manner or state of the main-clause event and modifies the main clause.” (Maeda 2004, *Annual Report of Gakushuin University Faculty of Letters*, 50, 115–134.)
- In manner clauses, there are three semantic relationships with the main clause:
 1. **State/metaphor** – e.g., “She said, ‘I found it,’ **as if she were surprised**”; “As humans have life, plants also have life.”
 2. **Degree/limitation** – e.g., “I dislike [it] so much I don’t even want to see its face”; “I tried doing as much as I could.”
 3. **Accompanying situation** – e.g., “I entered the bath **with glasses on**”; “I took a walk **while taking the dog along**.”

Reference: Maeda N. (2004). “On Manner Clauses in Contemporary Japanese: Their Systematicity and Continuity,” *Annual Report of Gakushuin University Faculty of Letters*, 50, 115–134.

5. Conjunctive Particles

Some common conjunctive particles (used in rule 5) include:

- **ba** – “If it rains, the match will be canceled.”
- **to** – “When you open the door, a cat jumps out.”
- **tomo** – “Even if you fail, keep trying.”
- **do (domo)** – “Even though I study, my grades don’t improve.”
- **ga** – “The weather is good, but the wind is strong.”
- **te (de)** – “I ate and went out.”
- **tsutsu** – “While feeling danger, I continued the investigation.”
- **nagara** – “I study while listening to music.”
- **temo (demo)** – “No matter how many times I read it, I can’t understand.”
- **keredo (keredomo)** – “I was tired, but I worked hard until the end.”
- **noni** – “I prepared hard, but I failed.”
- **node** – “Because I caught a cold, I skipped school.”
- **kara** – “I bought it because it was cheap.”
- **shi** – “It’s hot, and I’m sleepy, and I have no motivation.”
- **tari (dari)** – “I watched a movie and shopped.”
- **nari** – “As soon as I got home, I fell asleep.”

6. Compound Connective Expressions

- **mono no** – “I promised to meet him, but I couldn’t go after all.”
- **tokoro de** – “Even if we run from now, we won’t make it in time.”
- **kekka** – “As a result of studying hard, I passed.”
- **eikyō de** – “Due to the rain, the match was canceled.”
- **kagiri** – “As far as I know, he has never lied.”
- **ijō (wa)** – “Once you have made a promise, you must keep it.”

- **ni shitagatte** – “As you get older, your physical strength declines.”
- **ni tsurete** – “As the temperature drops, the leaves change color.”
- **ni atatte / ni saisite** – “When starting a new job, preparation is necessary.”